relevance to China, if it were to be successful in confronting the powerful Western challenge.

Interestingly, though Japan had defeated China in 1894–95, it was seen in China as having succeeded in becoming a modern nation and, therefore, a model to be emulated. Several Chinese students and scholars headed to Japan around the turn of the century to learn from its example. In contrast, India was regarded as a teacher by negative example, a failed and fallen country which had been subjugated and enslaved, virtually without resistance from its people. As pointed out by the Japanese scholar Shimada, '. . . reformers and radicals alike shared the anxiety that China not follow in the footsteps of India'.[1]

Kang Youwei was an advocate of constitutional monarchy, with the Meiji Restoration of Japan as the model. He became an adviser to the Qing emperor Guangxu and was associated with the 100 Days of Reform, but fell victim to the powerful reactionary clique around Empress Dowager Cixi. He went into exile to escape execution, and it was during his exile that he visited India from 1901–03 and again later, in 1909. It was from India that he criticized the move by some reformers for Guangdong province to declare independence, adopt radical reforms and then seek to overhaul the reactionary Qing monarchy at the centre. He wrote to his student, Liang Qichao:

> My 4 million compatriots, if you wish to become a fallen nation of slaves, then quickly support the fight for independence in all provinces like the Indian people have done. But if my compatriots, you do not wish to become a fallen nation or an exterminated race, then you should deem useless India's fight for independence in all its provinces.[2]

Here, Kang sought to compare Guangdong province with Bengal, which had fallen prey to the British because of the failure of various Indian princely states of India to present a united front under a strong central authority.

Other Chinese intellectuals sought to explain India's plight as a colonized country through the inherent character of its people. In his earlier writings, the scholar Zhang Taiyan argued that the Indian people were especially susceptible to British occupation after their experience with the Mongols